

Ideation Phase

Define Problem Statements (Detailed Theory)

Project: Freelancer Web Application (MERN Stack)

Date	10 April 2026
Team ID	Your Team ID
Project Name	Freelancer Web Application (MERN)
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Introduction to Problem Statements

A problem statement is a structured explanation of an issue that users face in real-world scenarios. It plays a crucial role in the design thinking process as it helps in clearly defining the problem before jumping into solutions. A well-defined problem statement ensures that the development process remains user-focused and aligned with real needs.

In the context of software development, especially web applications, problem statements help developers understand user expectations, identify pain points, and design systems that provide meaningful and efficient solutions. Without a clear problem statement, there is a high chance of building features that do not solve actual user problems.

For the Freelancer Web Application developed using the MERN stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js), problem statements are defined from two major perspectives: clients and freelancers. Both users face unique challenges that need to be addressed for building a successful platform.

Importance of Problem Statements

- Helps in understanding user needs clearly
- Provides direction for system design and development
- Ensures user-centric approach
- Helps in identifying key features of the system
- Reduces development errors and unnecessary features

Customer Problem Statements

PS	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
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PS-1	A client (startup owner/business)	Hires freelancers for projects	Unable to verify skills and reliability	Lack of transparency and poor filtering system	Results in delays, poor outcomes, and lack of trust
PS-2	A freelancer (student/developer)	Seeks online freelance work	Struggles to find reliable projects	High competition and presence of fake listings	Difficulty in securing work and fair exposure

Detailed Explanation of Problem Statements

Problem Statement 1 (Client Perspective):

Clients often face difficulty when hiring freelancers because there is no guarantee of skill verification and reliability. Many platforms do not provide adequate filtering or validation mechanisms, making it hard to choose the right candidate. This results in delays, poor project outcomes, and lack of trust in online hiring systems. Therefore, a platform that ensures verified profiles and transparent information is necessary.

Problem Statement 2 (Freelancer Perspective):

Freelancers, especially beginners and students, struggle to find genuine projects due to high competition and fake listings. Many job postings are either not authentic or highly competitive, making it difficult for new freelancers to secure work. This leads to frustration and lack of motivation. A system that ensures genuine opportunities and fair exposure is essential.

User Pain Points Analysis

The identified problem statements highlight several pain points experienced by users:

- Lack of trust between clients and freelancers
- Difficulty in verifying skills and authenticity
- High competition and low visibility for beginners
- Security concerns in payments and transactions
- Inefficient communication between users

Impact of These Problems

These problems negatively impact both users and the overall freelancing ecosystem. Clients may face project delays or poor quality work, while freelancers may struggle to build their careers. This creates a gap in the market for a reliable and efficient platform.

Proposed Solution

To address these challenges, the proposed solution is to develop a MERN-based Freelancer Marketplace Web Application that focuses on:

- Verified user authentication and profiles
- Transparent hiring and bidding system
- Secure payment integration
- Real-time communication between users
- Fair opportunities for freelancers
- Rating and review mechanisms

Conclusion

The problem statements defined above provide a clear understanding of user challenges and expectations. These insights will guide the design and development of the Freelancer Web Application to ensure it is user-friendly, reliable, and efficient. By addressing these issues, the platform can provide a better experience for both clients and freelancers.